

The Sandwich Locus

Second edition: the cell's $D(2)$ is closed at $\sqrt{\lambda^*} = 1.2771421129$, an algebraic point of degree three (the minimal polynomial $108x^3 - 415x^2 + 522x - 216$), certified globally over the line-atom family and connected to the full rank-two variety by the corner-reduction strictness chain — the parity-odd shell theorem proved, the 1-D closure discovered, the trade-off isolated. The complex and affine completions close with the phase gauge. The empirical face integrated: the three experiments (spectral compression, the register and the obstruction, the sheaf stratum) and the end-bit-from-record synthesis. The first edition's retraction and lens criterion stand unchanged.

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